



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Covenant School of Jacksonville
School Website: <https://wearecovenant.org/>

December 21, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

The Covenant School of Jacksonville, FL (Jacksonville 32207) presents a robust Classical Christian program with strong explicit religious foundations, a formation-centric purpose, and a clearly articulated classical curriculum and pedagogy. Across public-facing materials, the school repeatedly foregrounds a biblical worldview, the cultivation of wisdom and virtue, and a liberal-arts framework anchored in the grammar–logic–rhetoric Trivium, Latin, and Hillsdale K-12 resources. The public materials also showcase a college-agnostic emphasis on character, virtue, and spiritual formation, with memories of “great books” and Socratic dialogue threaded through upper grades, and a living-faculty as the “living curriculum.” Parent partnerships and community involvement are emphasized as integral to the Covenant model.

Overall classification (across six Classical rubric categories): CLASSICAL, with Element 3 (Curriculum) showing strong classical elements but slightly less explicit articulation of the explicit “Great Books / Great Conversation” framework in public wording, yielding a high-confidence SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL for that category. The aggregate assessment remains CLASSICAL, driven by broad alignment in religious foundations, formation-focused aims, classical curriculum elements, Socratic/seminar pedagogy in upper grades, a faculty described as the living curriculum, and active parent/community partnership.

- Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot is below, followed by a detailed, category-by-category keyword analysis and justification. The full abstract appears at the end.
- What would move the needle: Given Element 3’s partial alignment (Curriculum) with the classical “Great Books / Great Conversation” emphasis not always explicitly stated in website copy, concrete steps could include clearly naming Great Books / Great Conversation as a curricular pillar on the site, expanding explicit discussion of the Trivium’s Great Conversation tradition, and weaving explicit references to Great Books or canonical Western texts into grade-level narratives. This would strengthen the explicit public alignment with the core classical criterion and push Element 3 toward a fuller CLASSICAL rating.
- Abstract: A concise synthesis of the six-category evaluation and the aggregate classification is provided at the end of the report.

Note: All assessments below are grounded in the school’s public materials and the knowledge-rubric from the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School (1), with explicit quotations and references to the source materials.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The Covenant School of Jacksonville identifies itself as a “classical Christian school” and emphasizes equipping students with knowledge, wisdom, virtue, and joy within a Christian framework. This is stated plainly in multiple pages and headlines. - Public statements describe education as grounded in a biblical worldview, the integration of faith with learning, and formation in God-centered terms. Examples

include phrases like “biblical worldview,” “God’s glory,” and explicit references to Christian formation. - The school notes Hillsdale K-12 curriculum integration (a hallmark of many classical Christian schools) and asserts that “Covenant is the first private school in Florida... licensed Hillsdale curriculum” with a focus on math, science, literature/language arts, and history under a Christian framework. This demonstrates a theological/Metaphysical anchoring within a liberal-arts program. - The arts and music are framed within the aim of directing students toward “God’s truth, His goodness, and His beauty,” tying aesthetic formation to spiritual formation.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: wisdom, virtue, truth, beauty, faith-based worldview, God/God’s glory, biblical worldview, moral formation, sacred tradition, spiritual depth, mentorship. These align with the Positive Keywords set (e.g., wisdom, virtue, virtue/character, truth, beauty, moral formation, spiritual depth, sacred tradition, deliberative inquiry, etc.). - Negative keywords present: none evident in the public materials (no direct emphasis on secular, purely skills-based, or job-focused framing that would indicate a non-classical approach). The materials foreground formation, virtue, and transcendental values rather than purely instrumental aims.

Why this rating - The materials consistently foreground transcendental goods (truth, goodness, beauty) within a theologically grounded, Christian framework, and they explicitly position Covenant as a “classical Christian” program with a biblical worldview and God-centered formation. This aligns strongly with Classical school criteria in the Religious and Metaphysical Foundations category, yielding a CLASSICAL rating.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The public materials frame education as formation toward virtue and wisdom, rather than mere workforce preparation, with explicit aim for character and moral formation (“knowledge, wisdom, virtue, and joy” and formation-of-humankind language). - The school’s narrative emphasizes formation (“formation rather than information”) and a human-excellence orientation rooted in a Christian vision, with phrases like “formation of human beings” and “God-centered paideia.” The “Perry Family” and other testimonials emphasize God-focused formation and virtue as core outcomes. - A principal public statement chairs the mission as preparing students to influence others for the glory of God, the good of neighbors, and the greatness of the country—an explicitly formation-centered, non-workforce-tilted aim.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: virtue, wisdom, formation, character development, habits of the heart, moral imagination, soul formation, unity of faith and learning, love of learning, moral excellence, mentorship. These map to Positive Keywords in the Six Elements document. - Negative keywords present: virtually none (no operationalization around “career readiness,” “skills-based training,” or other work-force framing is evident in the site copy). The absence of secular, purely utilitarian aims supports CLASSICAL.

Why this rating - Covenant’s stated purpose emphasizes formation, virtue, and a biblical worldview as the aim of education, not simply job skills or information transfer. The rhetoric aligns with the Classical ideal of forming virtuous, wise humans rather than training for immediate work outcomes, supporting CLASSICAL.

Element 3: School Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Grammar Stage emphasis and a Trivium framework are explicit: Lower School lays the foundation in a Grammar Stage; students memorize and apply fundamentals (math facts, grammar rules, dates, Scripture). This is a core classical element. - The curriculum is described as “classical education” with Latin central to the program (Latin curriculum across middle/high grades; Wheelock; Memoria Press). The public materials show a stepped Latin sequence and classical language emphasis. - Hillsdale K-12 curriculum is used for History; the Hillsdale framework is a hallmark of classical education that supports the Great Conversation approach (though explicit “Great Books” naming is not consistently shown in the public copy). The site notes Hillsdale integration and a focus on core disciplines within a liberal-arts framework. - Upper School content references Socratic dialogue, logic, and rhetoric (the Logic and Rhetoric stages, dialogue, analytical writing, deep reading of classical texts), indicating a classical pedagogy rooted in the

Trivium. - There are mentions of music, fine arts, and Latin as complements to core disciplines, reinforcing a liberal-arts approach.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: grammar, logic, rhetoric, Great Books/Great Conversation (via classical framework and “Socratic dialogue” in upper school), Trivium (grammar/logic/rhetoric), Hillsdale K-12 Curriculum, Latin, classical literature, standard of “living books” in formation-focused context, and the emphasis on “great conversation” through the classical approach (where mentioned). The explicit Great Books language is not consistently present in all pages, but the Great-Conversation lineage is reflected via the Socratic dialogue and classical-readings orientation in upper grades. Positive keywords like grammar, logic, rhetoric, Latin, Hillsdale history, and Great Books/Great Conversation themes are evidenced in the materials. - Negative keywords present: Limited. The site’s copy emphasizes “hands-on,” “interactive,” and “experiential” elements in some places, which may resemble project-based or activity-driven descriptors; however, in classical rubric terms these do not negate the overarching classical curriculum and are typically framed as part of a holistic classical education rather than modern skills-based curricula. The explicit, job-centric, or strictly “skills-based” labeling is not prominent. The absence of explicit “Great Books” labeling in every section reduces the purity of the “curriculum = Great Books” criterion, yielding a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating rather than full CLASSICAL.

Why this rating - Covenant shows strong classical curriculum characteristics (Grammar Stage, Trivium, Latin, Hillsdale History, strong classical pedagogy in upper grades with Socratic dialogue). However, the public materials do not consistently name Great Books / Great Conversation as an explicit curricular anchor in every section, which is a hallmark criterion in the knowledge rubric. Given the mixture of explicit classical-tradition elements and less explicit Great-Books labeling in the public materials, the Curriculum category is classified as SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Upper School pedagogy includes Socratic dialogue, seminars, debates, and explicit training in logic and rhetoric, with opportunities to deliver rhetorical speeches. This is a canonical Classical approach at the Logic/Rhetoric stages. - Lower School emphasizes a foundation in grammar and memory-friendly approaches (e.g., recitation, memory work, and a memory-rich classroom culture) consistent with the Grammar Stage of classical pedagogy. While not the entire lower-grade text is shown here, the public materials indicate a memory-centered, song/recitation-friendly approach in early grades. - The school emphasizes the arts as a vehicle for forming the heart and mind toward God’s truth and beauty, including exposure to music, drama, and visual arts, with a focus on beauty and virtue, integrated into the learning process. This aligns with classical pedagogy that sees aesthetic formation as central to education. - The public copy indicates a deliberate integration of a classical pedagogy with a biblical worldview, and the faculty is described as guiding learners through time-tested literary and curricular resources.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Socratic dialogue, seminars, debate, logic, rhetoric, Great Conversation (via the upper-school pedagogy), grammar-stage memory work, “hands-on” but knowledge-driven learning, and the arts integrated as a vehicle for formation. These align strongly with the Positive Keyword indicators for Pedagogy in classical education. - Negative keywords present: none evident; no explicit signaling of exclusively non-classical pedagogies or heavy emphasis on project-based, standardized-testing-centric or purely skills-driven instruction without a formation aim. The pedagogy remains rooted in classical methods.

Why this rating - The teaching methods align closely with classical pedagogy: memory-focused Grammar Stage in early years, Socratic dialogue and rhetoric in the upper grades, and a structured, liberal-arts-based curriculum taught through classical modes. This justifies a CLASSICAL rating for Pedagogy.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The faculty are described as “the living curriculum,” modeling virtue, skill, and knowledge, and forming the core of the school culture. This is a hallmark of classical schools where teachers themselves embody the curriculum’s values. - The public materials emphasize a gifted and experienced teaching staff,

with a focus on forming students' hearts and minds and partnering with families, reinforcing a teacher-as-mentor paradigm. - Testimonials and faculty testimonials reinforce that teachers are central to the school's identity as a faith-based liberal-arts program; the staff is presented as virtuous and aligned with the school's mission.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: "living curriculum," "model teachers," "mentors," "faculty of friends," "core of the school," "living curriculum," "guardians of wisdom" (as indicative phrases in the materials). These map to the Positive Keywords set (teacher as mentor, living curriculum, virtuous faculty, etc.). - Negative keywords present: none evident; no content suggests a non-classical faculty approach. The materials emphasize virtue, mentorship, and classical formation through faculty leadership.

Why this rating - The materials position faculty as models of virtue, the living curriculum, and the core of the school culture. This is quintessentially CLASSICAL.

Element 6: Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The Covenant model emphasizes partnership with Christian families as co-educators and emphasizes mutual formation between home and school. The site explicitly notes "a tremendous blessing and privilege to partner with Christian families ... to equip this generation, and generations to come." This demonstrates a co-teaching posture with parents. - The school speaks about educating parents and engaging families in understanding classical education (via book studies, gatherings, etc.) and welcomes parental involvement with tours and inquiries. The public materials discuss "partnering with parents" and "co-teachers with the school" language in the context of classical education (and there are offerings for parent education, gatherings, etc.). - The "Affording Covenant" and "Bridge the Gap" materials show a broader community and donor engagement, reinforcing a strong community orientation that includes families in the school's mission.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with parents, co-teachers, parent education, community gatherings, family-centric language, biblical worldview, and joint cultivation of virtue and wisdom. These align with Positive Keywords around parental/community involvement and the living, shared educational journey. - Negative keywords present: none evident; there is no material signaling "parental disengagement" or "community fragmentation." The content emphasizes engagement and partnership.

Why this rating - Covenant presents a robust partnership with parents, invites parent involvement, and positions parents as co-educators within a classical framework, which matches CLASSICAL expectations for Parents & Community.

What Would Move the Needle

- Element 3 (Curriculum): To move fully CLASSICAL, explicitly foreground Great Books / Great Conversation as a public-facing curricular pillar. Add explicit language about canonical Western texts and the Great Conversation in grade-level narratives and mission statements, and reference to canonical authors or works within core courses. Strengthen cross-page consistency about Great Books and explicitly link the Hillsdale K-12 History Curriculum with Great Books/Great Conversation to align with classical expectations. Consider publishing a concise public-facing statement that articulates how Great Books, classical literature, and timeless texts anchor the curriculum across grade bands.
- Element 1–6 (No major needle-moving changes needed beyond minor enhancements): If desired, expand explicit liturgical and communal practices (e.g., explicit language about worship-centered or liturgical activities as part of school life) to strengthen Liturgical/Communal Practices evidence. The current materials emphasize a God-centered and worshipful framing through theology and Christian formation but do not clearly describe liturgical practices as a distinct educational pillar.
- Additional notes: Continue to foreground the "living curriculum" concept, and consider publishing a short, accessible policy or guide describing how faculty development, mentorship, and parental partnership work together to form virtue and wisdom in students.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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